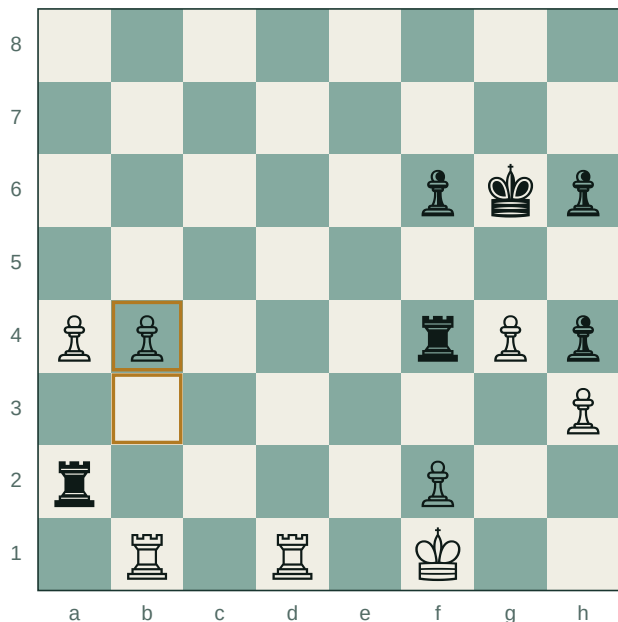


Rook-ending tactics: Black, move 37

Rook-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 37.b4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

37...Rxf2+ 38. Kg1 Rg2+ 39. Kh1 Rh2+

37...Rxf2+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on f2. Recorded reply: **38.Kg1**.

38...Rg2+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **39.Kh1**.

39...Rh2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here.

At the end, nominal material is White 14 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from -2 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on f1. Absolute pin: pawn on f2.